

Italy

Sovereign government data centre network — capacity, legal posture, provider landscape and migration path.

1 Starting point

Population	58.94 m
GDP	EUR 2,258 bn
Public administration (NACE O)	1,159 k
Electricity price	220.3 EUR/MWh
Renewables	40.7%
Live hyperscaler regions	4

2 What is structurally different

- High seismic risk. Base isolation or seismic-rated structures are mandatory, not optional, at the primary site; the second and third regions should be chosen in a different seismic domain so a single event cannot take out two regions. Expect facility CAPEX above the EUR 10 m/MW planning figure.
- Expensive power (220 EUR/MWh vs. EU average ~184). Power is the dominant OPEX line; free cooling, heat reuse, and siting near renewables or nuclear baseload move the economics more than server choice does. The model's power OPEX line is the number to attack first.
- Dense hyperscaler presence (4 live regions). Commercial capacity, fibre and skills exist in-country; the sovereign core can stay lean and the hybrid model works as designed. The risk is the opposite one: political pressure to declare a hyperscaler region 'sovereign enough' (Dutch GOAL.md section 17: location is not sovereignty).

3 Capacity

Servers	14,774 (CPU 10,208 / GPU 671 / storage 3,895)
IT critical load	24.1 MW
Facility design load	36.1 MW
Sites	4 (by capacity 4, floor 4)
Average per site	9.0 MW
Site count set by	capacity
CAPEX	EUR 857 m
OPEX	EUR 97 m / yr

4 Proposed geography

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
Milan / Lombardy	Primary civil cloud	36%	13.0	PSN pair, MIX, all four hyperscaler regions nearby; Po flood zoning.
Rome / Lazio	Sovereign secondary	18%	6.5	Ministries, Sogei, NAMEX; Apennine seismic zoning.
Turin / Piedmont	Government / continuity	18%	6.5	Alpine hydro, TOP-IX; lower seismicity.
Puglia / Bari	Defense / industrial	18%	6.5	Southern separation, Adriatic cable landings; renewables belt.
Emilia / Bologna	Strategic reserve	10%	3.6	EuroHPC Leonardo campus (Tecnopolo); reserve - 2023 flood plains excluded.

First-pass geographic hypotheses encoding only the obvious constraints, to be replaced by scored site selection.

5 Legal and regulatory posture

Governing instrument	Polo Strategico Nazionale (PSN) with mandatory migration deadlines for central administrations
Cloud certification	ACN cloud qualification (formerly AgID) with ordinary/critical/strategic data tiers
Data classification	Legge 124/2007: Riservato / Riservatissimo / Segreto / Segretissimo
Procurement route	Consip central purchasing; PSN concession held by TIM, CDP, Leonardo and Sogei

Foreign jurisdiction exposure. PSN runs Azure, Google and Oracle technology under Italian operator control; strategic data must stay on the national stack

Under the US CLOUD Act and FISA 702 a provider subject to US jurisdiction can face a lawful order for data it holds regardless of where that data sits. Residency is necessary but not sufficient; what matters is who holds the keys and who can be compelled.

6 Current state and provider landscape

Government cloud	Polo Strategico Nazionale (PSN) - operational since 2023, TIM/Leonardo/CDP/Sogei consortium, 4 DC pairs; ACN cloud qualification regime (Strategia Cloud Italia)
Maturity	federated
Digital identity	SPID / CIE (IT-Wallet in rollout)
Interconnection	MIX Milan; NAMEX Rome; landings Genoa, Sicily, Bari

7 Migration path and cost

Phase	Scope	MW	CAPEX	Cumulative	Hybrid
1	Sovereign core	8.7	EUR 166 m	19%	no
2	Security and defense	12.7	EUR 308 m	55%	no
3	State record	6.5	EUR 163 m	74%	no
4	Elective	8.3	EUR 219 m	100%	yes

Phase 1 is the number that matters: **EUR 166 m** for 8.7 MW, 19% of total CAPEX. That is the floor below which no hybrid arrangement helps — and it is a small fraction of the full build.

8 Geography and threat notes

High seismic/volcanic (Apennines, Naples, Etna); Po/Emilia floods (2023); gas-import dependent with structurally high power price; north-south grid bottlenecks (Lombardy hosts most capacity); low geopolitical frontline risk